

- * There is a difference between stressors and toxic exposure that weakens organisms, like the radiation I discussed in [Chapter 8](#) with the story of the rats.
- † There is a sociology-of-science dimension to the problem. The science writer Gary Taubes has convinced me that the majority of dietary recommendations (about lowering fats in diets) stand against the evidence. I can understand how one can harbor beliefs about natural things without justifying them empirically; I fail to understand beliefs that contravene both nature and scientific evidence.
- * The financial equations used by the villains for the “random walk” is based on heat diffusion.
- * The argument often heard about primitive people living *on average* less than thirty years ignores the distribution around that average; life expectancy needs to be analyzed conditionally. Plenty died early, from injuries; many lived very long—and healthy—lives. This is exactly the elementary “fooled by randomness” mistake, relying on the notion of “average” in the presence of variance, that makes people underestimate risks in the stock market.